The *Daily Mail* took the lead. Its headline: *Harry's girl is (almost) straight outta Compton.* Subhead: *Gang-scarred home of her mother revealed—so will he be dropping in for tea?*

Another tabloid jumped into the fray with this jaw-dropper: *Harry to marry into gangster royalty?*

My face froze. My blood stopped. I was angry, but more: ashamed. My Mother Country? Doing this? To her? To us? Really?

As if its headline wasn't disgraceful enough, the *Mail* went on to say that Compton had been the scene of forty-seven crimes in the last week alone. Forty-seven, imagine that. Never mind that Meg had never lived in Compton, never even lived near it. She'd lived half an hour away, as far from Compton as Buckingham Palace was from Windsor Castle. But forget that: Even if she *had* lived in Compton, years ago or currently, so what? Who cared how many crimes were committed in Compton, or anywhere else, so long as Meg wasn't the one committing them?

A day or two later the *Mail* weighed in again, this time with an essay by the sister of London's former mayor Boris Johnson, predicting that Meg would…do something…genetically…to the Royal Family. "If there is issue from her alleged union with Prince Harry, the Windsors will thicken their watery, thin blue blood and Spencer pale skin and ginger hair with some rich and exotic DNA."

Sister Johnson further opined that Meg's mother, Doria, was from "the wrong side of the tracks," and as stone-cold proof she cited Doria's dreadlocks. This filth was being blasted out to three million Britons, about Doria, lovely Doria, born in Cleveland, Ohio, graduate of Fairfax High School, in a quintessentially middle-class part of Los Angeles.

The Telegraph entered the fray with a piece slightly less disgusting, but equally insane, in which the writer examined from all angles the burning question of whether or not I was legally able to marry a (gasp) divorcée.

God, they were already into her past and looking at her first marriage.

Never mind that my father, a divorcé, was currently married to a divorcée, or my aunt, Princess Anne, was a remarried divorcée—the list went on. Divorce in 2016 was deemed by the British press to be a scarlet letter.